



City of Cambridge

POR 2026-117
FIRST IN COUNCIL
June 1, 2026

COUNCILLOR SIMMONS
MAYOR SIDDIQUI

- WHEREAS: On the 19th of June, people throughout the country shall be celebrating Juneteenth, which commemorates the day in 1865 during which slavery was formally abolished in the State of Texas, and which has come to be regarded as the final, formal date of emancipation of all remaining enslaved people throughout the United States of America at the end of the Civil War; and
- WHEREAS: On June 17, 2021, President Biden signed into law legislation declaring Juneteenth to be a federal holiday, and we celebrate this holiday each year in acknowledgment of the ending of one of the most shameful chapters in this country's history, and in the continual hope that the United States shall forever strive to become a more perfect union, and shall forever work to move closer to its founding ideals of being a nation where all citizens are considered equal; and
- WHEREAS: In the 161 years since the end of the Civil War, the United States has unquestionably made great strides, and has also suffered numerous, at times heartbreaking setbacks, in the long march towards true civic equality for all its citizens; and
- WHEREAS: In these tumultuous times, when the hard-won progress of generations faces renewed challenge and uncertainty, it is particularly important that we pause to commemorate Juneteenth and to reflect upon its meaning and enduring value – not merely as a remembrance of what was overcome, but as a reaffirmation of the principles of freedom, dignity, and equality to which this nation has pledged itself; and
- WHEREAS: Juneteenth remains an important date for us to pause each year to reflect upon the progress we have made, and to contemplate the work that remains as we seek to create a more just country for the generations yet to come; now therefore be it

ORDERED: That the City Council go on record recognizing June 19, 2026 as Juneteenth in the City of Cambridge, and in urging all Cambridge residents to reflect upon the meaning of this important day.

In City Council June 1, 2026.

Adopted by a ye and nay vote:-

Yeas 9; Nays 0; Absent 0.-

Attest:- Paula M. Crane, Interim City Clerk

A true copy;

A handwritten signature in cursive script, reading "Paula M. Crane".

ATTEST:-

Paula M. Crane
Interim City Clerk

Vote Certification

That the City Council go on record recognizing June 19, 2026 as Juneteenth in the City of Cambridge, and in urging all Cambridge residents to reflect upon the meaning of this important day.

Adopted: Monday, June 1, 2026

RESULT: 9 TO 0

YEAS: Ayah A. Al-Zubi, Burhan Azeem, Timothy R. Flaherty, Marc C. McGovern, Patricia M. Nolan, E. Denise Simmons, Jivan Sobrinho-Wheeler, Catherine Zusy, Sumbul Siddiqui

NAYS:

PRESENT:

ABSENT:



City of Cambridge

That the City Council go on record recognizing June 19, 2026 as Juneteenth in the City of Cambridge, and in urging all Cambridge residents to reflect upon the meaning of this important day.